



a AI Highlight ▾

Physical trauma reactions can continue after the danger is over, even when you know you're safe. With complex or developmental trauma, direct work on the deepest memory can be overwhelming, so a gradual approach may be enough: Buddhist nun Pema Chodron calls it a “feather touch,” and Peter Levine, the founder of Somatic Experiencing, calls gentle work around the edges “pendulation.” In inner-child therapy, you can know exactly what the younger part needs and still get pulled so far into the child-state that there isn't enough adult perspective left to give it.

